HELP DESK TICKET RESOLUTION IMPROVEMENT

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

1. Executive Summary

The project aims to improve service desk visibility, reduce open-ticket SLA breaches, and give managers a consistent view of ticket performance. It focuses on defining a clear ticket lifecycle, proactive SLA escalation rules, and KPI dashboard requirements. The project summary reports an approximately 25% reduction in open-ticket SLA breaches; the baseline and measurement period should be confirmed before treating this figure as a formally validated result.

2. Business Background

Service desk teams need to know which tickets are new, being assessed, actively worked, resolved, or closed. When ownership and SLA risk are not visible, teams may discover overdue tickets too late and managers may need to manually compile performance reports. A standardised workflow and shared dashboard can improve prioritisation, accountability, and decision-making.

3. Business Problem Statement

- Tickets approaching or exceeding SLA deadlines may not receive attention early enough.
- Ticket status and progression may be interpreted inconsistently across agents or teams.
- Managers lack a consolidated view of MTTR, ticket volumes, and SLA compliance.
- Escalation actions may depend too heavily on manual monitoring and follow-up.

4. Business Objectives

1. Improve visibility of ticket status, ownership, priority, age, and SLA risk.
2. Reduce open-ticket SLA breaches through timely warning and escalation.
3. Standardise ticket progression from New through Triage and Resolution to Closure.
4. Provide operational KPIs to help managers identify backlogs and service bottlenecks.
5. Support measurable before-and-after evaluation using an agreed baseline.

5. Project Scope

In Scope

- Documenting ticket lifecycle statuses and allowed transitions.
- Defining SLA monitoring, warning thresholds, escalation rules, and notification expectations.
- Defining dashboard requirements for MTTR, ticket volume, SLA compliance, at-risk tickets, and open breaches.
- Creating process flows, state transition diagrams, and dashboard wireframes.
- Defining business acceptance measures and stakeholder sign-off.

Out of Scope

- Replacing the full IT service management platform.
- Redesigning unrelated IT processes such as asset or change management.
- AI-based ticket classification or automated root-cause analysis unless separately approved.
- Changing contractual SLA targets without service-owner approval.

6. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Responsibility
Service desk agent	Review assigned tickets, update statuses, record work notes, and act on alerts.
Team lead	Monitor queue health, review at-risk tickets, and coordinate escalations.
Service desk manager	Own operational targets, review KPI trends, and approve workflow rules.
Business analyst	Elicit requirements, document processes, resolve requirement gaps, and coordinate validation.
ITSM administrator / owner	Configure workflows, SLA calendars, permissions, notifications, and dashboards.
Business / service owner	Approve priorities, SLA definitions, escalation rules, and reporting expectations.

7. Business Requirements

ID	Requirement	Business need
BR-01	Ticket visibility	Users can identify ticket status, owner, priority, age, and SLA position.
BR-02	Consistent lifecycle	Tickets follow documented stages with clear entry and exit conditions.
BR-03	Proactive SLA management	At-risk and breached tickets are highlighted and escalated using approved rules.
BR-04	Operational reporting	Managers can review ticket volume, MTTR, and SLA compliance for a selected period.
BR-05	Actionable queue	Users can filter and sort tickets by urgency, ownership, status, and SLA state.
BR-06	Traceability	Status, ownership, escalation, resolution, and closure events are auditable.
BR-07	Measurable improvement	The team can compare SLA breach performance against an agreed baseline.

8. Business Rules and Assumptions

- SLA targets, priority mapping, business hours, holidays, and pause conditions must be approved by the service owner.
- The approximately 25% reduction in open-ticket SLA breaches is a reported project result, not a guaranteed future outcome.
- Only authorised users may change ownership, priority, or workflow status.
- A ticket should not be closed until required resolution details and closure conditions are satisfied.

- Optional waiting statuses may be used when a ticket depends on requester or third-party input.
- Proposed statuses and thresholds must be validated against the existing ITSM configuration.

9. Success Measures

Measure	Definition	Validation
Open-ticket SLA breach rate	Share of open tickets that have exceeded their applicable SLA target.	Compare baseline and post-implementation periods.
MTTR	Average elapsed time from the agreed start event to resolution.	Approve start/stop rules; compare by period and priority.
Ticket volume	Tickets created, resolved, reopened, and remaining open.	Reconcile counts with source ticket records.
SLA compliance	Eligible tickets resolved within SLA divided by eligible resolved tickets.	Validate against SLA calendars and exclusions.
Escalation effectiveness	Where measurable, at-risk tickets acted on before breach.	Review escalation logs and ticket histories.

10. Risks and Dependencies

- Incomplete ticket data may reduce dashboard accuracy.
- Unclear SLA definitions may produce inconsistent breach calculations.
- Too many alerts may cause alert fatigue; thresholds should be tested with users.
- Workflow implementation depends on platform features and administrator permissions.
- A reliable baseline is required to validate the reported 25% reduction.

11. Business Acceptance and Sign-off

Before implementation, the service owner and service desk manager should approve the lifecycle, SLA rules, escalation recipients, KPI definitions, and dashboard layout. Acceptance should include agent user testing and reconciliation of dashboard figures against a sample of source tickets.

12. Open Questions

- Which ticketing platform and edition will host the workflow and dashboard?
- What SLA targets apply by priority, service, and ticket type?
- Which business-hours calendar, holidays, and pause conditions apply?
- What warning/escalation thresholds and recipients should be configured?
- What definitions and date ranges were used to calculate the reported 25% reduction?

Document status: Draft for stakeholder review. Confirm assumptions and KPI definitions before implementation.